

heart of the city. For \$100 a month you can get a decent, one-bedroom apartment within two blocks of any of them: Copacabana, Ipanema/Leblon, or São Conrado. With the \$643 a month left over you can eat at the best restaurants, go to the wildest nightclubs, rent sailboats, or go hang gliding. When you're tired of spending money you can flop on the beach for an hour or two.

It took Vicki and me about two seconds to adjust to Rio. But even fussier Americans seem to have a fairly easy time settling in. Brazilians are extremely patient with foreigners, especially those who try to speak Portuguese. And Brazilians hardly seem to notice when "silly" Americans choose to eat lunch at noon rather than two or three hours later—like "normal" people.

One way to make a little money in Rio is to sublet your apartment for \$500 during *Carnaval*, Brazil's one-week bash in late February and early March. Take the opportunity to fly up north, to Bahia or Recife, to get away from the crowds. By subletting your apartment you'll pay for your trip and have a few hundred dollars left over.

The history of the modern world is the history of Europe. Anyone interested in art, music, language, communications, science, and engineering starts his studies with Europe. In good times and bad, war and peace, most of what's important in our culture dates from somewhere in Europe. And Madrid is one of Europe's great capitals.

When you go to Madrid, think about those who went before you. Five hundred years ago, for example, the expatriate Christopher Columbus went to Madrid to lean on King Ferdinand and Queen Isabella. He wanted some dough for an overseas voyage, quite a risky venture in those days. The king and queen had finally driven the Moors out of Spain, and they were acquisition-minded. Think of them as the Carl Icahn and Saul Steinberg of the fifteenth century. So Columbus had an easy time getting the money, and he proceeded to